

Olympiad Test Paper — Sanskrit (Class 7) — Paper 4

Chapter 7: ईशावास्यम् इदं सर्वम् (Ishavasyam Idam Sarvam)

Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Sanskrit (NCERT Class 7, Deepakam)
Chapter	7 — ईशावास्यम् इदं सर्वम् (Ishavasyam Idam Sarvam)
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. National-Olympiad traps: ईशा is INSTRUMENTAL ('by the Lord'), not a nominative or vocative; the verse's vowel-sandhi joins are ईशा+वास्यम् (आ+अ→आ, savarna-dirgha) and इदम्+सर्वम् (anusvara, not visarga); भुञ्जीथाः is an OPTATIVE/imperative-mood middle 2nd-sg ('you should enjoy'), never a past or a noun; मा + गृधः is the PROHIBITIVE (मा + aorist stem, no augment अ-) meaning 'do not covet', not a future or a simple negative न; कस्यस्वित् is an indefinite GENITIVE ('of whose-ever') asking 'whose is wealth?'; त्यक्तेन is instrumental of the past-participle त्यक्त ('by renunciation'), the paradox of enjoyment-through-letting-go — NOT 'by grabbing'; detachment means non-attachment to ownership, NOT abandoning all action or treating the world as worthless. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. ईशावास्यम् इदं सर्वम् opens a verse whose second line is तेन त्यक्तेन भुञ्जीथाः. Reading both lines together, the verse's single argument is best summarised as:

- (A) because the world belongs to the Lord, humans may take nothing and should starve
- (B) because the Lord owns everything, only priests may use the world's goods
- (C) because all this is pervaded by the Lord, you should enjoy the world through detachment (treating nothing as your own to grab)
- (D) because nothing is divine, you may grab as much wealth as you can

2. In ईशावास्यम् the word ईशा is in which grammatical case, and what does that case contribute to the meaning?

- (A) instrumental — it marks the Lord as the agent 'by whom' all this is pervaded
- (B) nominative — it makes the Lord the subject that performs an action

(C) vocative — it is a direct address, 'O Lord!'

(D) genitive — it shows the world belongs 'to the Lord'

3. The opening word ईशावास्यम् results from joining ईशा + वास्यम्. The vowel change is best described as:

(A) आ + अ producing इ by guna substitution

(B) अ + इ producing ए by the standard vowel-junction rule

(C) two short अ vowels producing a single short अ

(D) आ followed by व (a consonant) needs no merger; but where आ meets a homogeneous vowel a long vowel results — here the आ of ईशा simply stands before वास्यम्, the long आ being the instrumental ending itself

4. इदम् + सर्वम् is written इदं सर्वम् in the verse. The change of इदम् to इदं before स is an instance of:

(A) final म् becoming visarga (ः) before a sibilant

(B) final म् becoming anusvara (ं) before a following consonant

(C) final म् doubling into म् before स (D) loss of the म् entirely with no replacement

5. तेन त्यक्तेन भुञ्जीथाः contains the instrumental त्यक्तेन ('by that which is renounced'). त्यक्तेन is the instrumental of which kind of form?

(A) a future-tense verb ('he will renounce'), from the -स्य- marker

(B) a present-tense verb ('they renounce'), 3rd person plural

(C) the past passive participle त्यक्त ('renounced, abandoned'), from the root त्यज्

(D) an imperative command ('renounce!'), 2nd person singular

6. भुञ्जीथाः ('you should enjoy') is which person, number, and mood?

(A) 2nd person singular, optative (विधिलिङ्) middle voice — 'you should/may enjoy'

(B) 3rd person plural, present tense — 'they enjoy'

(C) 1st person singular, future tense — 'I shall enjoy'

(D) 2nd person singular, past tense — 'you enjoyed'

7. मा गृधः कस्यस्विद्धनम् forbids covetousness. The negative मा here is paired with गृधः to form which construction?

(A) the prohibitive — मा with an aorist stem (lacking the augment अ-) expressing 'do not covet'

(B) a simple present negation — मा meaning the same as न with a present verb

(C) a future prohibition — मा with the -स्य- future stem

(D) a polite request — मा softening an imperative into 'please do'

8. Why does गृधः in मा गृधः NOT take the past-tense augment अ- (which would give अगृधः)?

(A) because गृधः is actually a present-tense form, which never takes the augment

(B) because the augment is dropped only in poetry for the metre, with no grammatical reason

- (C) because मा itself supplies the augment, so adding अ- would be redundant
(D) because the prohibitive मा-construction uses the bare aorist stem without the augment, even though the form is built on the aorist

9. कस्यस्वित् in कस्यस्विद्धनम् is built from कस्य + स्वित्. What does the addition of स्वित् do to the genitive किम्?

- (A) it turns the genitive into an instrumental, 'by whom'
(B) it negates the word, giving 'of no one'
(C) it makes the genitive INDEFINITE — 'of whose-ever / of anyone's', heightening the rhetorical force of the question
(D) it makes the word plural, 'of which many'

10. कस्यस्वित् + धनम् is written कस्यस्विद्धनम्. The change of त् to द् before ध arises because:

- (A) a final त् always doubles before any consonant
(B) a final unvoiced त् becomes the voiced द् before a following voiced consonant (here ध)
(C) a final त् becomes visarga before an aspirated consonant
(D) the त् is dropped and ध alone remains

11. A student paraphrases तेन त्यक्तेन भुञ्जीथाः as 'enjoy by grabbing what others have given up'. Why does this invert the verse's meaning?

- (A) त्यक्तेन means 'by YOUR OWN renunciation' (non-attachment), so one enjoys by NOT clinging — not by seizing what others discard
(B) त्यक्तेन means 'by giving up enjoyment', so the verse actually forbids all enjoyment
(C) त्यक्तेन means 'by the discarded things', so the verse tells you to live on others' leftovers
(D) त्यक्तेन means 'by future renunciation', so enjoyment is postponed to the next life

12. The verse's logic moves in steps: (1) the Lord pervades all; therefore (2) ____; therefore (3) do not covet anyone's wealth. The correct middle step is:

- (A) nothing is truly your exclusive private property, so you should enjoy with detachment
(B) the Lord will punish those who use any of the world's goods
(C) only the Lord may enjoy the world, so humans must abstain entirely
(D) the world is unreal, so wealth and poverty are equally meaningless

13. यत्किञ्च जगत्यां जगत् ('whatever moving thing exists in the world') extends सर्वम्. The phrase यत्किञ्च is built from यत् + किम् + चित्/च and means:

- (A) 'which one only', restricting the claim to a single chosen thing
(B) 'why indeed', turning the line into a question
(C) 'that little', limiting the claim to small things
(D) 'whatsoever', an indefinite relative covering every single thing without exception

14. In जगत्यां जगत्, the same root जगत् appears twice in different roles. The locative जगत्याम् and the nominative जगत् mean, respectively:

- (A) 'by the world' and 'to the world', two case-relations of motion
- (B) 'the world will move' and 'the world moved', two tenses of a verb
- (C) 'O world!' and 'world's', a vocative and a genitive
- (D) 'in the world (the universe as container)' and 'the moving thing (each transient creature/object within it)'

15. The detachment ethic of the verse is sometimes mistaken for world-denial. The chapter's own pairing of भुञ्जीथा: ('you should ENJOY') with त्यक्तेन ('by renunciation') shows that the intended attitude is:

- (A) total withdrawal from the world into silent isolation
- (B) engaged enjoyment of life held lightly — participate fully, but without grasping ownership
- (C) indifference to whether one lives or dies
- (D) maximising pleasure now since the world is the Lord's gift to consume

16. A wealthy person reads मा गृधः कस्यस्विद्धनम् and concludes 'I may keep all I have already earned; the verse only forbids taking MORE.' The deepest flaw in this reading is:

- (A) the verse actually commands giving away everything immediately, so keeping anything is wrong
- (B) the verse roots non-greed in the truth that nothing is one's own (all is the Lord's), so it reshapes one's relation to ALL wealth, not merely future acquisition
- (C) the verse forbids earning, so even past earnings are illegitimate
- (D) the verse is only about others' wealth, so one's own greed is never addressed

17. Comparing भुञ्जीथा: (optative) with a hypothetical imperative भुङ्क्ष्व ('enjoy!'), the verse's choice of the optative most precisely conveys:

- (A) a counselled 'you should/ought to enjoy' — guidance toward a wise attitude rather than a blunt order
- (B) a stronger command than the imperative, demanding immediate obedience
- (C) a past statement that one used to enjoy
- (D) a doubt about whether enjoyment is possible at all

18. Both त्यक्तेन and ध्यानेन (a worship-term from the chapter) end in -एन. Yet they function differently in their clauses. The shared grammatical fact is that both are:

- (A) genitive singulars naming a possessor ('of renunciation', 'of meditation')
- (B) locative singulars naming a place ('in renunciation', 'in meditation')
- (C) instrumental singulars naming the MEANS of an action ('by renunciation', 'by meditation')
- (D) accusative singulars naming a direct object

19. If one rewrote तेन त्यक्तेन भुञ्जीथाः to address a GROUP ('you all should enjoy'), the verb भुञ्जीथाः would become:

- (A) भुञ्जीत — the optative 3rd person singular
- (B) भोक्ष्यथे — the future 2nd person plural
- (C) भुञ्जीध्वम् — the optative 2nd person PLURAL middle
- (D) अभुङ्क्थाः — the past 2nd person singular

20. The prohibitive मा गृधः could be expanded with an explicit subject 'you'. Which expansion keeps both the mood and the meaning intact?

- (A) त्वं न गृह्णासि — 'you do not seize' (a plain present statement)
- (B) त्वं मा ग्रहीष्यसि — 'you will not seize' (a future)
- (C) त्वया मा गृह्यते — 'it is not seized by you' (a passive)
- (D) त्वं मा गृधः — 'you, do not covet'

21. Two readers debate the seam of ईशावास्यम्. Reader X says it hides ईश + अवास्यम्; Reader Y says ईशा + वास्यम्. The verse's grammar (instrumental sense 'by the Lord') supports:

- (A) Reader X — ईश (nominative) + अवास्यम् ('not to be dwelt-in')
- (B) neither — the word is a single unanalysable root
- (C) Reader Y — ईशा (instrumental of ईश) + वास्यम्, yielding 'to be pervaded BY the Lord'
- (D) both equally, since the meaning is the same either way

22. वास्यम् (in ईशावास्यम्) carries the force of '_____', which is why the line means 'to be enveloped/pervaded by the Lord'.

- (A) 'one who dwells' — an agent noun, 'the dweller'
- (B) 'he dwelt' — a simple past tense
- (C) 'a dwelling place' — a concrete noun, 'a house'
- (D) '(that which is) to be dwelt-in / enveloped' — a gerundive (future passive participle) of वस् 'to dwell, to clothe'

23. A devotee insists the verse means 'the Lord IS pervaded by all this', reversing agent and patient. The single grammatical fact that refutes this is:

- (A) ईशा is nominative, so the Lord is the subject being acted upon
- (B) ईशा is instrumental ('by the Lord'), so the Lord is the AGENT of pervading, while इदं सर्वम् (nominative) is what gets pervaded
- (C) इदं सर्वम् is instrumental, so 'all this' is the agent
- (D) both words are accusative, so neither is agent or patient

24. The chapter's wider ethic (worship, meditation, non-greed) and the verse's मा गृधः together imply that the OPPOSITE of the verse's ideal person is one who:

- (A) treats the world as private property to be seized and hoarded, ignoring that all is the Lord's
- (B) enjoys the world's goods while holding them lightly
- (C) worships the Lord through meditation and Name-chanting
- (D) gives generously, expecting nothing in return

25. Why is the instrumental त्यक्तेन (rather than, say, an accusative त्यक्तम्) the grammatically right form to mean 'enjoy BY renunciation'?

- (A) the instrumental marks the MEANS/instrument of an action, and renunciation is the means by which right enjoyment is achieved
- (B) the accusative would be needed because renunciation is the direct object of enjoyment
- (C) the genitive would be needed because renunciation belongs to the enjoyer
- (D) the locative would be needed because enjoyment happens inside renunciation

26. A teacher says: 'भुञ्जीथाः and मा गृधः are in DIFFERENT moods.' Which pairing of moods is correct?

- (A) both are plain present indicatives ('you enjoy', 'you do not covet')
- (B) भुञ्जीथाः is imperative and मा गृधः is future
- (C) भुञ्जीथाः is optative (a counselled 'should enjoy'); मा गृधः is prohibitive (a forbidden 'do not covet')
- (D) भुञ्जीथाः is past and मा गृधः is optative

27. The verse balances a positive command and a negative one. Mapped to the detachment ethic, the positive भुञ्जीथाः and the negative मा गृधः respectively teach:

- (A) DO renounce all enjoyment; do NOT touch the world at all
- (B) DO acquire wealth; do NOT share it with anyone
- (C) DO enjoy the world (rightly, with detachment); do NOT covet what is not yours
- (D) DO worship idols; do NOT meditate

28. Suppose the verse had read मा गृहीहि instead of मा गृधः. A purist objects. The objection rests on the fact that the classic prohibitive requires:

- (A) the future stem, so neither form is acceptable
- (B) the aorist stem (गृधः) without augment, not the present-imperative stem (गृहीहि)
- (C) the optative stem, making गृधः itself wrong
- (D) the perfect stem, so both forms are wrong

29. Reading कस्यस्विद्धनम् as a rhetorical question ('whose, after all, is wealth?') strengthens the command मा गृधः because it implies:

- (A) wealth belongs to whoever can seize it first, so coveting is natural
- (B) wealth belongs only to the Lord's priests, so laypeople must not touch it
- (C) wealth does not exist at all, so the question is meaningless
- (D) no one truly owns wealth — it is all pervaded by the Lord — so coveting 'another's' wealth rests on a false premise of ownership

30. The detachment taught here is sometimes confused with laziness ('since nothing is mine, why work?'). The verse's own भुञ्जीथाः refutes this because enjoyment-through-renunciation presupposes:

- (A) complete inactivity, since action implies attachment
- (B) ceaseless toil to accumulate, since the Lord rewards effort
- (C) withdrawal from all enjoyment as a higher path
- (D) active, rightful participation in life — one engages and enjoys, merely without clinging to ownership

31. Within the chapter, ईशावास्यम् इदं सर्वम् and the epithet सर्वशक्तिमान् ('all-powerful') reinforce each other. Together they ground the non-greed command because:

- (A) an all-powerful Lord will seize human wealth, so one should hide it
- (B) a Lord who both pervades all and is all-powerful is the true owner of everything, so human claims of exclusive ownership — the root of greed — collapse
- (C) since the Lord is powerful, humans need not restrain greed; He restrains it for them
- (D) the Lord's power applies only in temples, so greed outside is permitted

32. A student parses भुञ्जीथाः as भुज् + future + 2nd singular and translates 'you will enjoy'. Identify the error.

- (A) भुञ्जीथाः has no -स्य- future marker; the -ई- belongs to the OPTATIVE, so it means 'you should enjoy', not 'you will enjoy'
- (B) the form is correct; भुञ्जीथाः really is a future
- (C) the error is only in the person; it is 3rd singular, 'he will enjoy'
- (D) the error is only in voice; it is active, not middle

33. The gloss ईश्वरेण व्याप्तम् and the verse-word ईशावास्यम् agree in meaning. The grammatical link that makes them equivalent is:

- (A) both put the Lord in the genitive, 'of the Lord'
- (B) both put the world in the instrumental, 'by the world'
- (C) both put the Lord in the INSTRUMENTAL (ईश्वरेण = ईशा) as the agent 'by whom' pervading happens
- (D) both are vocatives addressing the Lord directly

34. Consider the claim: 'Detachment in this verse means the world is an illusion to be escaped.' The verse-pair तेन त्यक्तेन भुञ्जीथाः contradicts this because it tells us to:

- (A) flee the world, since भुञ्जीथाः means 'you should renounce'
- (B) ENJOY the world (भुञ्जीथाः) — so the world is real and good to live in, only not to be grasped
- (C) ignore the world, since त्यक्तेन means 'the world is false'
- (D) destroy attachment by destroying the world itself

35. If you wanted to negate भुञ्जीथाः into a prohibition 'do not enjoy (greedily)', the construction parallel to मा गृधः would use:

- (A) न with the optative भुञ्जीथाः unchanged
- (B) मा with an augmentless aorist of भुज् (e.g. मा भुक्थाः)
- (C) मा with the future भोक्ष्यसे
- (D) न with the present भुङ्क्ते

36. The four key verse-words ईशा, त्यक्तेन, भुञ्जीथाः, गृधः represent four different grammatical categories. The correct matching is:

- (A) ईशा = instrumental noun; त्यक्तेन = instrumental participle; भुञ्जीथाः = optative verb; गृधः = aorist (in a prohibition)
- (B) ईशा = vocative; त्यक्तेन = present verb; भुञ्जीथाः = future verb; गृधः = noun
- (C) ईशा = nominative subject; त्यक्तेन = adjective; भुञ्जीथाः = imperative; गृधः = future
- (D) ईशा = genitive; त्यक्तेन = past verb; भुञ्जीथाः = present; गृधः = optative

37. A line of reasoning runs: 'All is pervaded by the Lord → therefore enjoy with detachment → therefore do not covet.' Removing which middle premise would make the jump from premise 1 to the non-greed conclusion INVALID?

- (A) the premise that the Lord is in temples — without it, the chain still holds unchanged
- (B) the premise that nothing is one's exclusive own (so grasping is baseless) — without it, 'all is the Lord's' alone does not forbid coveting
- (C) the premise that wealth is pleasant — it is irrelevant to the chain
- (D) the premise that the world moves (जगत्) — it is merely descriptive

38. तेन (in तेन त्यक्तेन) is an instrumental pronoun agreeing with त्यक्तेन. तेन त्यक्तेन together literally render as:

- (A) 'to that renounced one' — a dative pronoun and participle
- (B) 'of that renunciation' — a genitive phrase
- (C) 'that renounces' — a subject pronoun plus verb
- (D) 'by that renunciation' — the pronoun and participle both instrumental, agreeing in case

39. Applied ethics: a merchant, persuaded by the verse, decides to keep running his business but stops obsessing over profit and treats wealth as held in trust. This conduct most faithfully embodies:

- (A) मा गृधः taken as 'abandon all trade', so he should shut the business
- (B) कुलकलङ्कः, since any wealth-keeping shames the family
- (C) तेन त्यक्तेन भुञ्जीथाः — enjoying/using the world (his trade) through inner detachment
- (D) सर्वशक्तिमान्, the epithet describing his new power over money

40. Why is मा (the prohibitive particle) NOT interchangeable with न in मा गृधः?

- (A) मा and न are fully interchangeable; the choice is only stylistic
- (B) मा forbids an action (a command not to do); न merely denies a fact (a statement that something is not so)
- (C) न forbids actions while मा denies facts — the opposite of what is claimed
- (D) मा is plural and न is singular, so the difference is one of number

41. The whole verse can be read as answering the question 'How should a person who knows the Lord pervades all relate to wealth and the world?' The verse's integrated answer is:

- (A) use and enjoy the world rightfully but without clinging, and never covet what belongs to another, since all ultimately is the Lord's
- (B) renounce wealth and the world entirely and live as a beggar
- (C) accumulate as much wealth as possible and dedicate it to temples
- (D) treat the world as worthless and act with indifference toward it

42. A student writes the seam of ईशावास्यम् as 'ईश् (root) + आवास्यम्' and glosses आवास् as 'a residence'. The chapter-correct analysis instead takes ईशा as:

- (A) the bare root ईश् with no ending, functioning as a verb
- (B) an adjective ईश meaning 'similar', as in the English '-ish'
- (C) the vocative ईश, an address 'O Lord'
- (D) the instrumental case-form of the noun ईश, not the bare verbal root ईश्

43. Compare the verse's मा गृधः with an ordinary statement सः धनं न इच्छति ('he does not want wealth'). The crucial difference is that:

- (A) मा गृधः is a prohibition addressed to 'you' (don't covet!); सः...न इच्छति merely reports a fact about a third person
- (B) both are prohibitions addressed to the listener
- (C) मा गृधः is a factual report and सः...न इच्छति is the command
- (D) both are factual statements differing only in tense

44. The verse uses इदं सर्वम् ('all this') rather than naming particular objects. This choice of an all-inclusive phrase is essential to the non-greed argument because:

- (A) it lets the verse exempt one's own wealth from the Lord's pervasion
- (B) it restricts the claim to visible objects, leaving hidden wealth ungoverned
- (C) only if ALL things (not just some) are pervaded by the Lord does the conclusion 'no wealth is truly anyone's to covet' follow universally
- (D) it is merely poetic and carries no logical weight

45. Which single sentence states a MEANING, a GRAMMAR fact, and the chapter's ETHIC together without error?

- (A) ईशावास्यम् = 'the Lord is absent'; ईशा is nominative; therefore one may hoard freely
- (B) इदं सर्वम् = 'one temple'; भुञ्जीथाः is past; therefore the wise renounce nothing
- (C) ईशावास्यम् इदं सर्वम् = 'all this is pervaded by the Lord'; ईशा is instrumental ('by the Lord'); therefore one should enjoy with detachment and not covet (मा गृधः)
- (D) मा गृधः = 'do covet'; ईशा is genitive; therefore greed is encouraged

46. Detachment (वैराग्य / त्याग) as taught by तेन त्यक्तेन is BEST distinguished from mere external giving-up of objects by noting that the verse locates it:

- (A) in the physical removal of all objects from one's life
- (B) in the inner ATTITUDE toward possession (non-clinging), which can coexist with using the very objects one is detached from

- (C) in the transfer of objects to a temple or priest
- (D) in the destruction of objects so no one can possess them

47. A debater claims मा गृधः कस्यस्विद्धनम् only forbids THEFT (taking another's wealth by force). Why is this too narrow?

- (A) the verse forbids only lawful trade, not theft, which it permits
- (B) गृधः means to COVET/crave, an inner greed; the verse forbids the desire itself, of which theft is only one outward fruit
- (C) गृधः means 'to give', so the verse is about generosity, not theft
- (D) the verse addresses only the wealth of priests, so ordinary theft is untouched

48. The instrumental ईशा and the instrumental त्यक्तेन both answer the question 'by what / by what means?' — yet one names an AGENT and the other a MEANS. Which is which?

- (A) ईशा names the means and त्यक्तेन names the agent
- (B) ईशा names the AGENT ('the Lord, by whom all is pervaded'); त्यक्तेन names the MEANS ('renunciation, by which one enjoys')
- (C) both name agents, since the instrumental only marks agents
- (D) both name means, since the instrumental only marks means

49. Putting the chapter's vocabulary to work: a person who, knowing the Lord pervades all, still hoards, scorns the poor, and grabs others' wealth violates the verse and earns which chapter label?

- (A) सर्वशक्तिमान् — all-powerful, an epithet of the Lord
- (B) गन्धर्वः — a semi-divine being
- (C) कुलकलङ्कः — a stain on the family (one whose conduct disgraces it), the moral opposite of the verse's ideal
- (D) बुद्धिमान् — a wise person

50. Which restatement of the optative भुञ्जीथाः preserves its 'should/may' force most exactly?

- (A) त्वम् अभुङ्क्थाः — 'you enjoyed' (past)
- (B) त्वम् भोक्ष्यसे — 'you will enjoy' (future)
- (C) त्वम् भुङ्क्षे — 'you are enjoying' (present)
- (D) त्वया भोक्तव्यम् — 'it should be enjoyed by you' (a gerundive of obligation)

51. The verse's structure — a metaphysical claim (line 1) grounding an ethical command (line 2) — is best described as:

- (A) two unrelated claims simply placed side by side
- (B) a command (line 1) justified by a fact (line 2), the reverse order
- (C) two commands with no factual basis at all
- (D) an 'is' leading to an 'ought': because all is the Lord's (a fact), therefore enjoy with detachment and do not covet (a duty)

52. A reader treats सर्वम् (neuter nominative 'all') as if it were vocative ('O all!'). The error matters for the verse's logic because, read correctly, सर्वम् is:

- (A) a vocative, so the verse is calling out to the universe
- (B) an instrumental, so 'all' is the means of pervading
- (C) the nominative SUBJECT — the thing that is pervaded — so the sentence asserts a fact about 'all this', not an address to it
- (D) an accusative, so 'all' is the object of a verb of motion

53. Synthesising mood across the verse: the optative भुञ्जीथाः and the prohibitive मा गृधः both belong to the broad category of 'non-indicative' moods because they express:

- (A) completed past actions, which the indicative cannot show
- (B) what SHOULD or SHOULD NOT be done (recommendation and prohibition), not what merely IS the case
- (C) ongoing present facts, which only these moods can state
- (D) future certainties, guaranteed to happen

54. Why does कस्यस्वित् (indefinite 'of anyone') strengthen मा गृधः more than a plain कस्य ('of whom') would?

- (A) the indefinite extends the prohibition to ANYONE'S wealth without exception, leaving no loophole for some person's wealth being fair to covet
- (B) it narrows the prohibition to one specific named person's wealth
- (C) it changes the prohibition into a question about ownership only
- (D) it weakens the prohibition by making it apply to no one in particular

55. The deepest unity of ईशावास्यम् इदं सर्वम् and मा गृधः कस्यस्विद्धनम् is that the second is the practical CONSEQUENCE of the first. State that consequence-relation correctly:

- (A) since the Lord owns all, He will share wealth equally, so coveting is unnecessary
- (B) since the Lord pervades all, wealth is sacred and must be hoarded reverently
- (C) since the Lord owns and pervades all wealth, no wealth is another person's absolute property — hence coveting it is groundless and forbidden
- (D) since the Lord is everywhere, no wealth really exists, so the command is symbolic

56. Final synthesis: which statement is wholly correct across meaning, sandhi, grammar, and ethic?

- (A) ईशावास्यम् = ईशा (instrumental) + वास्यम् 'to be pervaded by the Lord'; इदम्+सर्वम्→इदं सर्वम् by anusvara; भुञ्जीथाः is optative 'you should enjoy'; मा गृधः is the prohibitive 'do not covet' — together: enjoy with detachment, covet nothing
- (B) ईशावास्यम् = ईश (vocative) + अवास्यम्; इदम्+सर्वम्→इदः सर्वम् by visarga; भुञ्जीथाः is future; मा गृधः is a present statement — so the wise hoard

(C) ईशावास्यम् has genitive ईश; इदं सर्वम् means 'one temple'; भुञ्जीथाः is past; मा गृधः means 'do covet' — so greed is praised

(D) ईशा is nominative; त्यक्तेन is accusative; भुञ्जीथाः is imperative; गृधः is a noun — so renunciation is the object enjoyed

57. The root गृध् (seen in गृधः) underlies the noun गृध्नु ('greedy'). Knowing this root-meaning, the single English word that best captures the inner state मा गृधः forbids is:

(A) 'covetousness / greed' — an inner craving to possess

(B) 'generosity' — a willingness to give (C) 'forgetfulness' — a failure to remember

(D) 'reverence' — a feeling of awe

58. Two students translate भुञ्जीथाः मा गृधः. Student P: 'You should enjoy; do not covet.' Student Q: 'You will be enjoyed; covet not.' Comparing voice and mood, the correct verdict is:

(A) Q is right — भुञ्जीथाः is passive, 'you will be enjoyed'

(B) both are right — the two renderings are equivalent

(C) neither is right — भुञ्जीथाः means 'they enjoyed'

(D) P is right — भुञ्जीथाः is active-sense middle 'you should enjoy', not a passive 'you will be enjoyed'

59. Applied reasoning: a king who has internalised ईशावास्यम् इदं सर्वम् is deciding how to treat the kingdom's resources. The verse's ethic would most precisely direct him to:

(A) seize every resource as royal property, since the king is the land's owner

(B) abandon the throne entirely, since owning anything is forbidden

(C) neglect the resources, since the world is the Lord's concern, not his

(D) govern and use the resources as a trustee for all (held in the Lord's name), enjoying their fruits without grasping them as personal possessions

60. The verse joins a positive duty and a negative duty into one ethic. Abstracting the principle behind both भुञ्जीथाः and मा गृधः, the unifying virtue is best named:

(A) asceticism — rejecting the world and its goods altogether

(B) acquisitiveness — accumulating as much as possible for oneself

(C) indifference — caring nothing for the world either way

(D) non-attachment (detachment) — engaging the world fully yet without possessive craving

Solutions — Sanskrit (Class 7), Chapter 7: ईशावास्यम् इदं सर्वम् (Ishavasyam Idam Sarvam) — Paper 4

Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, -1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	C	11	A	21	C	31	B	41	A	51	D
2	A	12	A	22	D	32	A	42	D	52	C
3	D	13	D	23	B	33	C	43	A	53	B
4	B	14	D	24	A	34	B	44	C	54	A
5	C	15	B	25	A	35	B	45	C	55	C
6	A	16	B	26	C	36	A	46	B	56	A
7	A	17	A	27	C	37	B	47	B	57	A
8	D	18	C	28	B	38	D	48	B	58	D
9	C	19	C	29	D	39	C	49	C	59	D
10	B	20	D	30	D	40	B	50	D	60	D

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

- (C)** The first line establishes that the Lord pervades the whole world; the second draws the ethical conclusion that one should enjoy it in a spirit of renunciation, not grasping it as private property. It neither forbids all use nor permits unlimited grabbing, and it does not restrict use to priests.
- (A)** The long final आ on ईशा is the instrumental singular ending (ईश + आ). It conveys 'by the Lord', the means/agent of the pervading, exactly as the gloss ईश्वरेण व्याप्तम् shows with its instrumental ईश्वरेण.
- (D)** ईशा already ends in the long instrumental आ and वास्यम् begins with the consonant व, so no vowel-merger occurs at the seam; the long आ is the case ending, not the product of two short vowels combining into ए.

4. (B) Word-final म् before a consonant in the same breath-group is regularly written as anusvara, so इदम् सर्वम् appears as इदं सर्वम्. It does not turn into a visarga, nor double, nor vanish.
5. (C) त्यक्त is the past participle of त्यज् ('to abandon'); त्यक्तेन adds the instrumental ending to mean 'by/through renunciation'. It is not a finite verb of any tense or mood.
6. (A) भुञ्जीथाः is the optative (विधिलिङ्) 2nd-singular ātmanepada of भुज्, carrying the sense 'you should enjoy / let you enjoy'. It is neither a present, future, nor past form.
7. (A) Sanskrit forbids an action with मा plus an aorist stem that drops the past augment अ-; so मा गृधः means 'do not covet'. The ordinary negative न negates statements, not commands, and no future marker is present.
8. (D) The defining feature of the prohibitive is मा + an aorist form stripped of its augment अ-; this is a grammatical rule, not a mere metrical licence, and मा does not supply the augment.
9. (C) The particle स्विच् attaches to interrogatives to make them indefinite; कस्य ('of whom') + स्विच् yields 'of anyone whatever', so मा गृधः कस्यस्विद्धनम् means 'do not covet anyone's wealth'.
10. (B) By voicing-assimilation, an unvoiced stop like त् becomes its voiced counterpart द् before a voiced sound such as ध, giving कस्यस्विद्धनम्. It neither doubles, becomes a visarga, nor disappears.
11. (A) The instrumental त्यक्तेन names the inner attitude of detachment as the MEANS of right enjoyment; one enjoys the world while holding nothing as one's own. It is not about scavenging others' leavings, nor a total ban on enjoyment, nor a deferral.
12. (A) Because everything is pervaded by the Lord, no part of it is anyone's absolute possession; this is why one enjoys with non-attachment and refrains from coveting. The verse neither threatens users, bans all enjoyment, nor declares the world unreal.
13. (D) यत्किञ्च is an indefinite expression 'whatever, whatsoever', reinforcing सर्वम् so that absolutely everything that moves in the world is included. It neither restricts to one thing nor poses a question.
14. (D) जगत्याम् is locative ('in the world'), naming the container, while जगत् here names that which moves within it; the repetition contrasts the encompassing world with each transient thing in it. Neither form is a verb or a vocative.
15. (B) Joining 'enjoy' with 'by renunciation' yields a paradox resolved as full engagement without attachment, not withdrawal, not indifference, and not unrestrained consumption.

16. (B) Because all wealth is pervaded by the Lord, the verse targets the attitude of possessive grasping itself, not just the act of acquiring more. It does not demand instant dispossession, nor forbid earning, nor confine itself to others' goods alone.

17. (A) The optative (विधिलिङ्) expresses what one ought to do, fitting the verse's tone of wise counsel; it is gentler than a direct imperative, not stronger, and is neither past nor a statement of doubt.

18. (C) The -एन् ending on a-stems is the instrumental singular; both words name the means by which something is done. They are not genitives, locatives, or accusatives.

19. (C) Keeping the optative middle but shifting from singular to 2nd-plural gives भुञ्जीध्वम् ('you all should enjoy'). भुञ्जीत is 3rd-singular, भोक्ष्यथे is future, and अभुङ्क्थाः is past.

20. (D) Adding the nominative त्वम् preserves the prohibitive मा + aorist गृधः. The other options shift to a present statement, a future, or a passive — none of which is a prohibition.

21. (C) The instrumental ईशा is exactly what gives the verse its sense 'pervaded by the Lord' (cf. gloss ईश्वरेण व्याप्तम्); Reader X's अवास्यम् would negate the very dwelling the verse asserts. The readings are not equivalent.

22. (D) वास्यम् is a gerundive ('to be enveloped/dwelt-in'); combined with the instrumental ईशा it yields 'to be pervaded by the Lord'. It is neither an agent noun, a past verb, nor a place-noun.

23. (B) The instrumental case on ईशा fixes the Lord as the agent and the nominative इदं सर्वम् as the patient; the directionality cannot be reversed. 'All this' is not instrumental, and ईशा is not nominative.

24. (A) The verse's ideal is detached enjoyment and non-coveting; its opposite is the grasping hoarder. The other options all describe the ideal, not its contrary.

25. (A) 'By means of X' is precisely the instrumental's job, so त्यक्तेन is correct. An accusative would make renunciation the thing enjoyed, which is not the sense.

26. (C) भुञ्जीथाः is the optative of counsel and मा गृधः is the prohibitive of forbidding; they are different but complementary moods. Neither is a plain indicative, and the labels in the other options are misassigned.

27. (C) The verse affirms right enjoyment (भुञ्जीथाः) and forbids covetous grasping (मा गृधः) — a single coherent ethic of detached engagement. It neither bans enjoyment outright nor endorses hoarding.

28. (B) Classical prohibition uses मा with the augmentless aorist (गृधः); मा गृहीहि mixes in the present-imperative stem, which the strict construction avoids. The required stem is the aorist, not the future, optative, or perfect.

29. (D) The rhetorical 'whose is wealth?' answers itself: ultimately no one's, since all is the Lord's; this undercuts the very idea of coveting another's property. It neither legitimises seizure nor reserves wealth for priests, nor denies that wealth exists.

30. (D) 'You should enjoy' assumes one is actively living and using the world; detachment governs the ATTITUDE, not whether one acts. It implies neither idleness, nor accumulation, nor withdrawal.

31. (B) All-pervasion plus omnipotence makes the Lord the real owner of all, dissolving the basis for possessive grasping. The verse places the duty of non-greed on the person, not on a wealth-seizing or temple-bound deity.

32. (A) The optative marker -ई- (not the future -स्य-) is what shapes भुञ्जीथाः, giving 'you should enjoy'. The mistake is in the MOOD/tense, not merely person or voice.

33. (C) ईश्वरेण and ईशा are both instrumentals of the Lord; that shared case is why the gloss and the verse-word mean the same thing. The Lord is not genitive or vocative here, and the world is not the instrument.

34. (B) The command to enjoy presupposes a real world worth living in; detachment qualifies how one holds it, not whether it exists. भुञ्जीथाः means 'enjoy', not 'renounce' or 'flee'.

35. (B) Just as मा गृधः uses मा + augmentless aorist, a prohibition of 'enjoy' would use मा + the aorist of भुज् (मा भुक्त्वाः). The plain न negates statements, not commands, and no future or present form fits a prohibition.

36. (A) ईशा and त्यक्तेन are both instrumentals (a noun and a participle), भुञ्जीथाः is an optative finite verb, and गृधः is the aorist used in the prohibitive. The other rows misclassify one or more of these.

37. (B) The bridge from 'the Lord pervades all' to 'do not covet' is the realisation that nothing is truly one's own; remove it and the conclusion no longer follows. The temple, pleasantness, and motion premises are not load-bearing for this inference.

38. (D) तेन is the instrumental of तद् ('that'), agreeing with the instrumental त्यक्तेन; together 'by that renunciation'. They are not dative, genitive, or a subject-verb pair.

39. (C) Continuing rightful work while releasing attachment to gain is exactly 'enjoyment through renunciation'. The verse does not demand abandoning livelihood, the merchant is not disgracing his family, and सर्वशक्तिमान् describes the Lord, not him.

40. (B) मा is the particle of prohibition (don't!), while न negates declarative statements; they are not interchangeable. The roles are not reversed, and neither marks number.

41. (A) The verse counsels detached enjoyment plus non-coveting, grounded in the Lord's pervasion of all. It endorses neither total renunciation, nor accumulation, nor indifference.

42. (D) ईशा is ईश plus the instrumental ending आ, giving 'by the Lord'; it is not the unmodified root ईश, not an '-ish'-style adjective, and not a vocative.

43. (A) मा गृधः commands the addressee not to act; सः धनं न इच्छति simply describes someone's lack of desire. One is a prohibition, the other a report — not the reverse, and not both reports.

44. (C) The universality of सर्वम् is what makes the non-greed conclusion apply to all wealth without exception; a partial claim would leave room for coveting the unpervaded remainder. The phrase exempts nothing and is logically load-bearing, not mere decoration.

45. (C) The correct row pairs the right meaning, the instrumental ईशा, and the detachment/non-greed ethic. Each wrong row contains at least one false meaning, case, or ethical inversion.

46. (B) Because the verse says to ENJOY by renunciation, the renunciation is inward (an attitude), compatible with still using things; it is not the physical disposal, donation, or destruction of objects.

47. (B) The root sense of गृध् is craving/coveting, an inner state; forbidding it covers more than the single act of theft. गृधः does not mean 'give', and the prohibition is not restricted to priests' wealth or to permitting trade-over-theft.

48. (B) The instrumental covers both agent and means; here ईशा is the divine agent of pervading, while त्यक्तेन is the means of right enjoyment. The roles are not reversed, and the instrumental is not limited to one function.

49. (C) Coveting and hoarding against the verse's ethic exemplifies disgraceful conduct, captured by कुलकलङ्कः. सर्वशक्तिमान् describes the Lord, गन्धर्वः is a semi-divine being, and बुद्धिमान् denotes the wise — none fits the greedy hoarder.

50. (D) The gerundive भोक्तव्यम् ('should be enjoyed') matches the optative's sense of what ought to be done. The past, future, and present forms each lose the 'should' force.

51. (D) Line 1 states what IS the case (the Lord pervades all) and line 2 derives what one OUGHT to do; the fact grounds the duty. The lines are related, the order is fact-then-duty, and line 1 is not itself a command.

52. (C) सर्वम् here is the nominative subject ('all this [is pervaded]'); reading it as a vocative would turn an assertion into an exclamation, breaking the verse's factual claim. It is neither instrumental nor a motion-object.

53. (B) Optative (counsel) and prohibitive (forbidding) both concern duty — what ought and ought not to be done — distinguishing them from the indicative's statements of fact. They do not assert past, present, or future facts.

54. (A) Making 'whose' indefinite (anyone's) closes every loophole, so no one's wealth is exempt from the ban on coveting. It neither narrows to one person, turns the command into a mere question, nor weakens it.

55. (C) The first line removes the very basis of private ownership, which is why coveting another's wealth is baseless and prohibited in the second. The verse neither promises divine redistribution, sanctifies hoarding, nor denies the existence of wealth.

56. (A) Only the first row gets every element right: the instrumental ईशा, the anusvara sandhi इदं सर्वम्, the optative भुञ्जीथाः, the prohibitive मा गृधः, and the detached-enjoyment/non-greed ethic. Each other row contains at least one false case, sandhi, mood, or ethical claim.

57. (A) गृध् denotes craving or greed, so मा गृधः forbids covetousness. It is the opposite of generosity, and has nothing to do with forgetting or revering.

58. (D) भुञ्जीथाः is the middle (ātmanepada) optative meaning 'you should enjoy' for oneself, with active sense, not a passive 'be enjoyed'. Q misreads the voice; the readings are not equivalent, and the form is not 3rd-person past.

59. (D) Detached enjoyment-as-trusteeship — using and benefiting without claiming absolute ownership — is the verse's direct application. It rules out possessive seizure, total abdication, and negligent indifference alike.

60. (D) Both the call to enjoy and the ban on coveting flow from one root virtue: non-attachment, which engages life without grasping. It is neither world-rejecting asceticism, nor acquisitiveness, nor indifference.